

# Joshua Safran

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## SUMMARY

iOS engineer with ten years of mobile and full-stack experience at startups including Peloton and GameChanger. Joined Peloton as its first iOS engineer at eight employees, built the company's first app from the ground up, and pitched and prototyped the video streaming experience that became a core branch of the product; later shipped GameChanger's first live streaming feature and led iOS engineering for parent company Dick's Sporting Goods. Experienced in hiring, mentoring, and leading small mobile teams, and in incident response for a platform peaking at 100,000+ concurrent sessions. Returning to full-time engineering after several years running a small business; currently building daily in Swift and SwiftUI.

## TECHNICAL SKILLS

**iOS & Mobile:** Swift, SwiftUI, UIKit, Objective-C, Core Data, Core Bluetooth, Core Image, Core Animation, StoreKit / in-app purchases, Keychain, XCTest, Xcode Instruments, App Store release workflow

**Architecture & Practice:** MVVM, MVC, TDD, unit and integration testing, code review, pull-request workflow, Git / GitHub, Jenkins, Docker, feature flags, Scrum, Kanban, mentoring

**Backend & Web:** Node.js, TypeScript, JavaScript, Python, SQL, MySQL, Redis, REST APIs, JSON, AWS, Datadog, FFmpeg, live video streaming

**Operations:** On-call rotation, incident triage and escalation, incident lead, rollbacks, production monitoring, technical post-mortems

**Additional:** C#, C++, Unity, AI-assisted development, UX/UI design, 2D illustration and animation

## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

**Small Business Owner & Independent Developer** — Geneva, NY

*Owner / Freelance Developer & Designer | 2021 – Present*

- Operate and maintain a pinball arcade and novelty shop, handling day-to-day operations, equipment upkeep, and customer experience.
- Build independent iOS projects in Swift and SwiftUI, including a camera and photo-booth application with a full Git branch and pull-request history, using AI pair programming daily for implementation, code review, and architecture exploration.
- Design and sell book cover illustration and artwork on a freelance basis; explore generative sculptural art using Houdini (VEX) and resin printing.

**GameChanger (Dick's Sporting Goods)** — New York, NY

*Senior iOS Engineer (promoted from iOS Engineer) | February 2018 – August 2021*

- Implemented live video streaming, the company's first, launched as a top-priority initiative during COVID when families could not attend youth sports in person.
- Led iOS engineering for parent company Dick's Sporting Goods during COVID: delivered curbside pickup under an urgent deadline and migrated the retail app's primary navigation from a hamburger menu to a modern tab bar.
- Owned feature delivery full-stack — TypeScript API endpoints and SQL data access through to user-facing iOS — shipping calendar, equipment inventory checklist, and deep linking features, and migrating legacy Objective-C to Swift.
- Served on the cross-company on-call rotation for the #1 youth sports app, covering 24-hour shifts twice monthly and monitoring Datadog and AWS through peak weekend load of 100,000–200,000 concurrent sessions; triaged production incidents via rollbacks and targeted server restarts, acted as incident lead coordinating live escalation calls, and authored technical post-mortems.
- Mentored and guided junior engineers as a lead engineer on an eight-person cross-functional team (five engineers plus manager, design, and QA), and supported hiring through phone screens, on-site interviews, and pair-programming assessments.
- Built runtime debug tooling in a company hackathon that let engineers and QA exercise hard-to-reach states and toggle feature flags from a running build.
- Contributed Android features and code review, worked on the internal staff tooling site, and wrote tests across every system touched.

**Independent Contractor** — Philadelphia, PA & Brooklyn, NY

*Developer & Designer | June 2015 – February 2018*

- Vibes: solo-built an augmented-reality iOS game played while walking the Philadelphia Museum of Art, with a server backend and Bluetooth proximity features driven by in-room sensors; won first place at the PMA Hackathon against 100+ competing teams.

- Exhibit Growth: built a photo booth iOS app for Umpqua Bank with a custom camera UI and stylized Core Image (CIFilter) effects.
- Story/Time: wrote a Bluetooth-to-OpenFrameworks communication library for experiential advertising firm FakeLove.
- Shipped independent games in Unity, handling code architecture, illustration, and animation; eight first-place game jam finishes.

#### **Peloton — New York, NY**

*Lead iOS Developer | November 2013 – June 2015*

- Joined as one of the company's first eight employees and its first and only iOS engineer; hired to bring the web purchasing experience to iPad, then pitched and prototyped the streaming app that became a core branch of Peloton's product focus.
- Built the company's first iOS and iPad app from the ground up; grew to 15,000+ active users and a 5-star App Store rating, and was selected by Apple for front-page App Store features.
- Worked directly with the CEO, CTO, and design lead to shape product direction; pitched and shipped user profiles that merged with profiles from Peloton's bike hardware, then in-app purchasing — the app's first monetization and a new revenue stream for the business — using a mixed renewing and non-renewing model with a Keychain-backed free trial.
- Implemented a custom video player with bespoke overlays and Bluetooth integration with heart rate monitors and other health devices; partnered with the backend team to design the iOS-serving video endpoints.
- Engineered a thumbnail grid over a library that grew past 3,000 videos, using background loading of adjacent cells plus preloading and caching schemes to keep browsing smooth across hundreds of items and network calls — central to the premium feel of the product.
- Instrumented user behavior and flow analytics when mobile analytics was still an emerging practice, and compiled actionable reports used across a company that grew to 100–200 employees to assess feature health and justify new investment, including the in-app purchase initiative.
- Built and maintained the retail sales app, expanding it from a single show-floor terminal to 15+ retail locations: multiple shopping and checkout flows, sales reporting, credit card reader integration, and user profile lookup for subscriptions and discounts. Also built an Apple Store-style kiosk display app for showroom floors and implemented serial-cable hardware communication for an experimental in-studio tablet.
- Hired and trained the team's second iOS engineer; owned internal software distribution and the relationship with Apple.

#### **Stray Boots — New York, NY**

*App Developer | January 2013 – November 2013*

- Built features for a cross-platform, client/server augmented-reality scavenger hunt app played on city streets, engineering for reliability under spotty and intermittent network conditions.
- Owned multiple release cycles and their in-house and external beta testing rounds; researched and implemented the analytics suite and integrated it into a live TV display.

#### **iDevices — Hartford, CT**

*Lead App Developer | September 2011 – November 2012*

- iGrill: took over an unstable contractor-built codebase for a Bluetooth thermometer product, stabilized it, and shipped social and geolocation features; App Store rating rose from 2 to 4 stars.
- iNotebook (Targus): shipped a hardware-integrated note-taking app with a two-person team using Bluetooth, Core Data, OpenGL, and custom UIKit; presented at CES 2013.
- Grew app development from a solo function to a four-person team, owning hiring for both engineering and art; built internal BLE prototyping tools, established Scrum practices, and co-authored contract statements of work.

### **EDUCATION**

#### **Rensselaer Polytechnic Institute — Troy, NY**

B.S. Computer Science and B.S. Games & Simulation Arts and Sciences, 2011 | RPI Medalist Scholarship

### **SELECTED AWARDS**

- First Place, Philadelphia Museum of Art Hackathon (2017) — augmented-reality game, 100+ competing teams. Eight first-place finishes across game jam competitions including Philadelphia Game Mechanics.
- First Place, RPI GameJam (2010); two-time award winner, RPI GameFest (2010, 2011). Second Place, Best Traditional Card Game, BoardGameGeek (2017). Three design awards for book cover illustration.